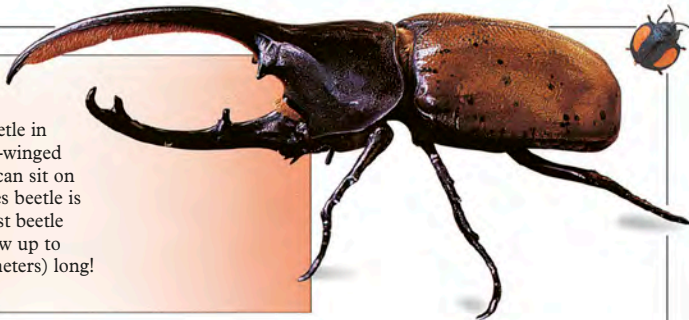


Little and large

The smallest known beetle in the world is the feather-winged beetle. It is so small it can sit on a pinhead. The Hercules beetle is thought to be the longest beetle in the world. It can grow up to seven inches (17 centimeters) long!



Fighting males lift each other off the ground. They do this by grabbing their opponent around the middle.



Night lights

Fireflies are not really flies, they are beetles. At night, the females put on a light show as they flash their tails to attract a mate. They are able to do this because they have a special chemical in their body.

Hard, antlerlike jaws.



Beetles have palps to help them sense food.



Valiant beetles



Rove beetle



Tortoise beetle



Giraffe beetle



Bombardier beetle

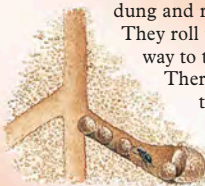
If it's attacked, it fires off a mixture of burning chemicals.

Roll over

Dung beetles go to a lot of trouble to find a safe and nutritious home for their young. They collect animal dung and roll it into large balls.

They roll the dung balls all the way to their underground homes.

There they lay their eggs in the dung. When the beetle larvae hatch, they discover a tasty meal in front of them!



Beetle storing dung

